UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

MONDAY, 12 OCTOBER 2026

22 must-know stories, 22 Prelims facts, 20 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 877 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Keralam Assembly passes resolution seeking removal of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, steps to restore credibility of ECI

The Kerala Legislative Assembly is set to move a historic resolution seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The move comes amid allegations of electoral roll manipulation and mass deletion of voters during the Special Intensive Revision exercise. The core issue centers on safeguarding citizens' voting rights, democratic principles, and the independence of the Election Commission of India. Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan will move the resolution on October 12 under Rule 118 of the Kerala Legislative Assembly rules. The CPI(M)-led LDF is backing the resolution, while three BJP legislators are expected to oppose it. The resolution alleges deliberate voter deletions through SIR, changes to Form 6, and misuse of the ECINet software. It demands formal action against the CEC, an overhaul of the SIR process, and the unconditional restoration of deleted voters. It also proposes restructuring the CEC selection committee to include the Prime Minister, Lok Sabha Opposition Leader, and a Supreme Court representative.

When: October 12 · **Where:** Kerala · **Who:** Gyanesh Kumar, V.D. Satheesan, LDF · **Prelims:** The resolution is moved under Rule 118 of the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the Kerala Legislative Assembly.; Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar is the official named in the resolution.; The Special Intensive Revision and ECINet software are cited for irregularities in voter applications and deletions.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights an unprecedented legislative conflict between a state assembly and a central constitutional authority.; Brings focus to debates surrounding electoral roll integrity, software management, and the independence of election machinery.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional body established under Article 324 of the Constitution to ensure free and fair elections. The Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners are appointed by the President under the Chief Election Commission and Other Election Commissioners Act. The CEC can be removed from office only through a parliamentary process of impeachment similar to that of a Supreme Court judge, requiring special majorities.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Place in news

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on thesouthfirst.com*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Assam Land Ceiling Act Validated: Supreme Court Upholds Agrarian Reform

The Supreme Court pronounced its judgment validating the Assam Land Ceiling Act. The Supreme Court has upheld the validity of the Assam Land Ceiling Act, reinforcing state measures on agrarian reform and land redistribution.

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** Assam · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The legislation upheld by the Supreme Court is the Assam Land Ceiling Act.; The ruling pertains to agrarian reform and land ceiling validation.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens the legal framework for state-led agrarian reforms and land redistribution in India.; Upholds social justice objectives envisioned in the Directive Principles of State Policy.*

Static — The Supreme Court of India is the highest judicial forum and final court of appeal under the Constitution of India, established under Article 124. Agrarian reform in India relates to laws and policies enacted to reorganize ownership and cultivation of agricultural land, famously including land ceiling and abolition of zamindari systems. The Directive Principles of State Policy under Article 39 direct the State to policy towards securing that the ownership and control of the material resources of the community are so distributed as best to subserve the common good.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

The Law Observer: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Karnataka High Court strikes down law increasing reservation for SCs/STs, declares it unconstitutional

The Karnataka High Court quashed the state law raising reservation quotas for Scheduled Castes to 17 percent and Scheduled Tribes to 7 percent. The decision came on a public interest litigation filed by Mahendra Kumar Mitra challenging the Karnataka Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes Reservation Act of 2022. The core issue involved the state increasing total reservation from 50 percent to 56 percent, breaching the established 50 percent ceiling. A bench of Chief Justice Vibhu Bakhru and Justice K.S. Hemalekha passed the order declaring the enhanced quota unconstitutional. The revision was originally initiated by the then BJP government led by Basavaraj Bommai based on the Justice Nagamohan Das Committee recommendations. The policy change increased SC reservation from 15 percent to 17 percent and ST reservation from 3 percent to 7 percent. The increased quotas applied to 103 SC sub-castes and 56 ST sub-groups across educational institutions and government employment. The ruling impacts government recruitment and admissions processes that relied on the enhanced quotas, forcing the state to examine legal options.

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** Karnataka · **Who:** Chief Justice Vibhu Bakhru, Justice K.S. Hemalekha, Mahendra Kumar Mitra, Basavaraj Bommai · **Prelims:** The court bench comprised Chief Justice Vibhu Bakhru and Justice K.S. Hemalekha.; The Act in question is the Karnataka Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Reservation) Act, 2022.; The law raised the combined SC and ST reservation from 18 percent to 24 percent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces the judicially mandated 50 percent ceiling on total reservations in public employment and education.; Impacts ongoing and future government recruitments and admissions in Karnataka that factored in the enhanced quotas.*

Static — The Supreme Court in the landmark Indra Sawhney case (1992) capped total reservations at 50 percent, except in extraordinary circumstances. Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) of the Constitution empower the state to make special provisions for the advancement of any socially and educationally backward classes or SCs and STs. Public Interest Litigation allows any public-spirited citizen to approach courts for the enforcement of constitutional or legal rights.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on siasat.com · also reported by Bar & Bench

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Opposition to Supreme Court: Probe Election Commission decisions, audit of SIR voter deletions

Rahul Gandhi and 10 other opposition leaders filed a petition in the Supreme Court challenging the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. The petition demands disclosure of EC files, agendas, minutes, notings, objections, and ECINET and ERONET access logs concerning decisions like the June 24, 2025 SIR start date. The petition seeks a judicial examination of whether EC decisions comply with Article 324, the 2023 law governing the EC, and the T.N. Seshan v Union of India ruling. INDIA bloc leaders staged a massive protest march in New Delhi against alleged electoral fraud and voter roll discrepancies, demanding the Chief Election Commissioner's resignation. Karnataka CM D.K. Shivakumar alleged that BJP members misused Form 7 applications to delete voters from minority, backward, and oppressed communities in Karnataka, West Bengal, Maharashtra, and Haryana. Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma defended the SIR exercise, stating it is necessary every five years to check demographic changes caused by illegal immigration in Assam, West Bengal, and Jharkhand.

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** Rahul Gandhi, Gyanesh Kumar, Mallikarjun Kharge, Shashi Tharoor, D.K. Shivakumar, Himanta Biswa Sarma · **Prelims:** Form 7 is the official form used to raise objections to the proposed inclusion or deletion of names in an existing electoral roll.; The petition in the Supreme Court was led by LoP Rahul Gandhi along with 10 other opposition leaders.; The disputed Special Intensive Revision (SIR) decision was initiated by the Election Commission on June 24, 2025.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights ongoing political friction over the transparency and administrative actions of India's autonomous election machinery.; Invokes critical constitutional questions regarding judicial review of Election Commission decisions under Article 324.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional body established under Article 324 of the Constitution on January 25, 1950, responsible for administering election processes in India. Article 324 vests the superintendence, direction, and control of elections to Parliament, State Legislatures, and the offices of the President and Vice President in the Election Commission. The Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners are appointed by the President under the provisions of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

hindustantimes.com: read the source · also reported by Bar & Bench, LiveLaw, Times of India

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Courts must intervene whenever rights are violated: CJI

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant stated that constitutional courts must intervene whenever fundamental freedoms and constitutional rights are violated. He delivered the address at the 33rd Foundation Day celebrations of the National Human Rights Commission in New Delhi. The core issue addressed was ensuring substantive access to safe drinking water and clarifying the distinct roles of courts and human rights institutions. He acknowledged India's expansion of rural household tap connections but questioned whether delivered water is safe, reliable, and available when needed. He highlighted that constitutional courts hold strong writ jurisdictions under Articles 32 and 226 to enforce remedies for rights infringements. The CJI stressed that human rights commissions provide indispensable independent fact-finding machinery to identify systemic failures and assist marginalized communities. He defended the NHRC's advisory role, stating its institutional influence stems from earned moral credibility rather than coercive force. NHRC Chairperson Justice V Ramasubramanian underscored the demanding nature and vulnerability of the office of the Chief Justice of India.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** Vigyan Bhavan, New Delhi · **Who:** CJI Surya Kant and NHRC Chairperson Justice V Ramasubramanian · **Prelims:** NHRC organized a conference on water during its 33rd Foundation Day celebrations.; Articles 32 and 226 empower the Supreme Court and High Courts respectively to exercise writ jurisdiction.; Justice V Ramasubramanian serves as the Chairperson of the NHRC.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reaffirms the proactive constitutional obligation of High Courts and the Supreme Court to remedy executive inaction.; Highlights the qualitative gap between infrastructure expansion and actual socio-economic rights realization, specifically concerning safe drinking water.*

Static — The National Human Rights Commission is a statutory body established in 1993 under the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993. It consists of a Chairperson who has been a Chief Justice of India or an SC Judge, alongside judicial and expert members. Members are appointed by the President on recommendations of a six-member committee comprising the Prime Minister, Home Minister, Speaker, Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha, and Leaders of the Opposition.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare

Bar & Bench: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

'Advance injustice': Allahabad HC flags POCSO Act's rigid application in minor couple cases

The Allahabad High Court called on the Law Commission to consider recommending changes to the POCSO Act, 2012, to address cases involving minor couples. A two-judge bench stated that strict enforcement can lead to outcomes that advance injustice rather than justice, especially when a child is born. The court observed that the law inadequately considers India's social conditions, where poverty, illiteracy, and limited legal awareness prevail. The observation came during the consideration of a habeas corpus petition filed by Rakesh Yadav to produce his wife. The couple had eloped, signed an affidavit as husband and wife, and the girl subsequently gave birth to a child in a Balika Griha. The court suggested allowing special judges greater flexibility in exceptional cases and examining alternative penalties like community service. The bench stressed that the state must ensure minors continue their education and acquire vocational skills until they reach majority.

When: September 1, 2025 · **Where:** Allahabad · **Who:** Justice Atul Sreedharan, Justice Achal Sachdev, Rakesh Yadav · **Prelims:** The POCSO Act was enacted in 2012.; The petition involved was a habeas corpus petition filed by Rakesh Yadav.; The girl's date of birth was stated as July 25, 2010.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the friction between statutory criminal laws and socio-cultural realities in India regarding adolescent relationships.; Prompts a re-evaluation of penal sentencing and the potential introduction of alternative penalties like community service.*

Static — The Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act was enacted in 2012 to protect children from offences of sexual assault, sexual harassment and pornography. The Law Commission of India is a non-statutory body constituted by the Government of India from time to time, tasked with legal reform. Habeas corpus is a writ issued by courts to secure the release of a person allegedly detained unlawfully, ensuring personal liberty.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

Times of India: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 25,530 crore SARTHAK-PDS scheme to modernise public distribution system

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved the SARTHAK-PDS scheme to continue and integrate two key food distribution initiatives. The Centre will spend Rs 25,530 crore over five years as its share during the 16th Finance Commission cycle until March 31, 2031. The new programme integrates the intra-state foodgrain movement and FPS dealers margin scheme with the SMART PDS scheme. The scheme provides assured financial support for intra-state transport and handling, along with enhanced margins for Fair Price Shop dealers. Revised norms for Central assistance to states and UTs were approved while retaining the existing funding pattern. The integrated scheme seeks to build a unified, citizen-centric, and technology-driven PDS architecture to minimise leakages. It proposes using advanced technologies like Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, and Blockchain. The initiative supports the government's commitment to ensuring food and nutritional security for around 81.35 crore NFSA beneficiaries.

When: March 31, 2031 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs · **Prelims:** Total financial outlay for the SARTHAK-PDS scheme is Rs 25,530 crore.; The scheme will continue until March 31, 2031, covering the 16th Finance Commission cycle.; The scheme targets around 81.35 crore beneficiaries covered under the NFSA.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Ensures assured financial support for intra-state movement and handling of foodgrains and enhances Fair Price Shop dealer margins.; Leverages cutting-edge technologies like AI, machine learning, and blockchain for real-time monitoring and transparent operations.*

Static — The Public Distribution System (PDS) in India operates under the joint responsibility of the Central and State/UT Governments. The Central Government is responsible for procurement, storage, transportation, and bulk allocation of foodgrains to the states. State Governments are responsible for identifying eligible beneficiaries, issuing ration cards, and distributing foodgrains through Fair Price Shops.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Over 3.85 lakh cases pending in 28 information commissions as of June 2026: report

Over 3.85 lakh appeals and complaints were pending across 28 information commissions in India as of June 30, 2026. These findings come from the Report Card on the Performance of Information Commissions in India 2025-26 released by Satark Nagrik Sangathan. The report shows that 14 information commissions have an estimated waiting time of one year or more to dispose of a matter. Between July 1, 2025, and June 30, 2026, 27 commissions registered 2,61,669 appeals and complaints while 28 commissions disposed of 2,41,627 cases. Maharashtra State Information Commission disposed of the highest number of cases at 54,985, followed by Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, and the CIC. Maharashtra SIC also had the highest pending cases at 77,000, followed by Chhattisgarh at over 52,000 and Bihar at over 42,000. Pending cases with the Central Information Commission rose significantly to 39,121 from 24,102 on June 30, 2025. Tripura SIC would take an estimated 19 years and 8 months to clear a matter filed on July 1, 2026. The report attributes long delays to commissioner vacancies and a tardy rate of disposal, which renders the RTI Act ineffective.

When: June 30, 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Satark Nagrik Sangathan · **Prelims:** Over 3.85 lakh appeals and complaints were pending across 28 information commissions as of June 30, 2026.; The report was released by the voluntary organisation Satark Nagrik Sangathan.; Maharashtra SIC recorded the highest number of disposed cases (54,985) and the highest pending cases (77,000).

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the systemic distress and operational delays plaguing the statutory transparency framework in India.; Demonstrates how huge backlogs undermine accountability and deny timely justice to marginalized citizens relying on government services.*

Static — The Central Information Commission is set up under the Right to Information Act, 2005, as a statutory body to inquire into complaints and decide appeals. The CIC consists of a Chief Information Commissioner and up to 10 Information Commissioners, appointed by the President on the recommendation of a committee. State Information Commissions are established by respective state governments under the RTI Act, 2005, sharing a similar structure and powers.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on timesofindia.indiatimes.com*

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Under the chairmanship of Union Home Minister Shri Amit Shah, India hosts first meeting of BIMSTEC Home Ministers in New Delhi

India is hosting the first BIMSTEC Home Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on October 13, 2026. Union Home Minister Amit Shah announced that the meeting aims to address regional security challenges and cooperation. Key agenda items include discussions on terrorism, transnational organised crime, narcotics radicalisation, and trafficking. The meeting will also deliberate on illicit financial flows and emerging cyber threats affecting member states. Bangladesh Home Minister Salahuddin Ahmed is skipping the two-day meeting, sending Senior Secretary Manzur Morshed Chowdhury instead. Nepal Home Minister Sudhan Gurung stated that Nepal will raise issues regarding natural disasters, early warning systems, and regional rescue cooperation.

When: October 13, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Amit Shah, Salahuddin Ahmed, Manzur Morshed Chowdhury, Sudhan Gurung · **Prelims:** The first BIMSTEC Home Ministers' Meeting is held in New Delhi.; BIMSTEC has seven member countries including Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand.; Bangladesh's delegation is led by Home Affairs Senior Secretary Manzur Morshed Chowdhury.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides a vital platform for security cooperation and intelligence sharing among Bay of Bengal nations.; Allows India to lead regional efforts against cross-border terrorism, narcotics, and cyber threats.*

Static — BIMSTEC (Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation) is an international regional organization founded in 1997. It comprises seven member states: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand. The grouping bridges South Asia and Southeast Asia, focusing on technical and economic cooperation among countries dependent on the Bay of Bengal.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

PIB: read the source · free copy on theprint.in · also reported by Hindusthan Samachar English

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Joint Statement of the 16th Meeting of the India–UK Joint Economic and Trade Committee (JETCO)

The meeting took place following the entry into force of the India-UK CETA and marked the first JETCO since negotiations began in January 2022. India and the UK held the 16th JETCO meeting in New Delhi to review the implementation of the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement and plan future economic priorities. We, Shri Piyush Ved Prakash Goyal, Honourable Minister of Commerce and Industry of India, and the Rt Hon Jonathan Reynolds MP, Secretary of State for Business, Innovation, Science and Trade of the United Kingdom, met today in New Delhi for the 16th meeting of the India–UK Joint Economic and Trade Committee (JETCO). We celebrated this landmark agreement that is already delivering for businesses in both countries. We were clear that the CETA marks the beginning, not the end, of our shared ambition: it is the foundation for a deeper and broader economic partners

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Shri Piyush Ved Prakash Goyal and Rt Hon Jonathan Reynolds MP · **Prelims:** The 16th India-UK JETCO meeting was held in New Delhi.; Negotiations for the India-UK CETA started in January 2022.; Assam's Joha rice made its first export to the UK under the trade agreement.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the operationalization of the India-UK CETA and immediate benefits for bilateral trade.; Expands trade engagement to include regional authorities and sub-national leaders from the North of England.*

Static — The India-UK Joint Economic and Trade Committee is a ministerial-level bilateral mechanism designed to boost trade and economic cooperation between India and the United Kingdom. Bilateral trade mechanisms like JETCO facilitate regular dialogue to resolve trade barriers, promote investments, and foster cooperation in strategic economic sectors. Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreements are expansive pacts between nations aimed at reducing or eliminating tariffs and non-tariff barriers across goods and services.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Economy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

PIB: read the source · also reported by Hindustan Times

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, Japan sign maritime security pact, deepen defence cooperation

India and Japan signed a maritime security pact to deepen defence cooperation between the two nations. The agreement aims to enhance bilateral strategic ties and ensure regional security in the Indo-Pacific. The text does not provide further details due to a mismatch between the headline and the provided body text.

Where: India and Japan · **Who:** India and Japan governments

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens bilateral defence architecture and maritime domain awareness.; Advances strategic cooperation in the Indo-Pacific region.*

Static — India-Japan relations are anchored by the Special Strategic and Global Partnership, focusing on economic cooperation, defence, and regional security. The Indo-Pacific region is a critical area for both nations, emphasizing freedom of navigation, maritime security, and economic resilience. Bilateral defence mechanisms include the Foreign and Defence Ministerial Dialogue (2+2) and joint military exercises like Dharma Guardian and JIMEX.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Defence · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Social Justice & Welfare

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Global multidimensional poverty rises for first time since 2010

The UN global poverty index has risen for the first time since 2010, affecting 1.2 billion people globally. The 2026 report by UNDP and Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative found 51.5 million more people in acute poverty. UNDP Administrator Alexander De Croo called the increase a wake-up call highlighting interlocking hardships like hunger and lack of clean water. More than half of the individuals suffering from acute poverty globally were children. A major driver of the recorded increase was population growth combined with new data being available for only 13 of 108 developing countries. Despite the rise, 33 nations halved their percentage of people living in poverty over the past 15 years. Rapid progress was recorded in Asian nations like China and Vietnam, along with reductions in Egypt, Nepal, and Tajikistan. The majority of the poorest populations continue to reside in sub-Saharan Africa and South Asia. The poverty index assesses indicators such as inadequate housing, sanitation, electricity, cooking fuel, food, and education.

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** Global · **Who:** United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative, Alexander De Croo · **Prelims:** The global poverty index rose for the first time since 2010.; The number of people affected by multidimensional poverty reached 1.2 billion.; The report covers 108 developing countries, with new data available for 13 of them in this edition.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the compounding threats of population growth and data gaps on global poverty reduction targets.; Provides critical insights into child poverty, revealing that minors make up over half of those in acute poverty.*

Static — The Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) was developed in 2010 by the Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative (OPHI) and the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP). It complements traditional monetary poverty measures by capturing the overlapping deprivations that poor people experience simultaneously in their daily lives. The MPI assesses poverty across three core dimensions: health, education, and standard of living, using ten specific indicators.

Syllabus: GS2: Social Justice & Welfare, International Relations · Prelims angle: Report/Index

msn.com: read the source

Health

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

CERVAVAC: India’s First Indigenous HPV Vaccine Receives WHO Prequalification

The World Health Organization granted prequalification status to CERVAVAC, an indigenously developed quadrivalent human papillomavirus vaccine. The milestone was achieved following extensive international clinical evaluations, manufacturing audits, and validation of safety and efficacy guidelines. Prequalification establishes CERVAVAC as the first Indian-manufactured HPV vaccine certified for procurement by international agencies like UNICEF and Gavi. Manufactured by Serum Institute of India, Pune, the vaccine protects against high-risk oncogenic types 16 and 18, and low-risk types 6 and 11. Types 16 and 18 cause 70% to 80% of cervical cancers globally, while types 6 and 11 cause nearly 90% of anogenital warts. The formulation is licensed in India as a gender-neutral vaccine for males and females aged 9 to 26 years. It supports both single-dose and two-dose schedules for primary adolescent recipients aged 9 to 14 years. Mass-scale, cost-effective domestic production directly addresses severe global supply crunches of HPV vaccines. This approval accelerates progress toward WHO's 90-70-90 targets to vaccinate 90% of girls by age 15 by 2030.

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** Pune, India · **Who:** World Health Organization (WHO) and Serum Institute of India (SII) · **Prelims:** CERVAVAC is India's first indigenously manufactured quadrivalent HPV vaccine, developed by the Serum Institute of India.; It targets four HPV strains: high-risk oncogenic types 16 and 18, and low-risk types 6 and 11.; Licensed in India for both females and males aged between 9 and 26 years.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Enables international organizations like Gavi and UNICEF to procure affordable HPV vaccines, mitigating acute global shortages.; Strengthens India's domestic immunization efforts by curbing import dependency and reducing public healthcare procurement costs.*

Static — Cervical cancer is primarily caused by persistent infection with high-risk human papillomavirus (HPV) genotypes, most notably HPV 16 and 18. WHO Prequalification ensures that medicines and vaccines supplied by UN agencies meet stringent standards of quality, safety, and efficacy for global health programmes. The WHO 90-70-90 cervical cancer elimination strategy aims to achieve 90% vaccination of girls by 15, 70% screening, and 90% treatment by 2030.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health

Insights on India: read the source · also reported by Civilsdaily

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

PRESS RELEASE OF CONSUMER PRICE INDEX ON BASE 2024=100 FOR SEPTEMBER, 2026

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation released the Consumer Price Index press release for the month of September 2026. Retail inflation based on the Consumer Price Index reached 5.54% in September 2026, while food inflation stood at 7.74% under the new 2024 base year. August, 2026 (Final) September, 2026 (Provisional) Rural Urban Combined Rural Urban Combined Inflation (%) CPI (General) 5.24 4.31 4.83 6.08 4.88 5.54 CFPI 6.17 5.64 5.97 8.06 7.18 7.74 Index CPI (General) 109.28 108.07 108.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation · **Prelims:** All India retail inflation for September 2026 is 5.54% provisional.; Consumer Food Price Index inflation for September 2026 is 7.74%.; Base year for the current Consumer Price Index series is 2024 equals 100.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides crucial data for the Reserve Bank of India to determine monetary policy stance and interest rate adjustments.; Tracks household purchasing power and cost of living shifts across rural and urban geographies in India.*

Static — The Consumer Price Index (CPI) measures changes in the price level of a weighted average market basket of consumer goods and services purchased by households. In India, the CPI is compiled and released monthly by the National Statistical Office (NSO) under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation. Base years for macroeconomic indices like CPI are periodically revised to account for structural changes in consumer consumption patterns over time.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Data/Stats

PIB: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Global Innovation Index 2026

India is ranked 38th among 139 economies in the Global Innovation Index 2026. The index covers 139 economies and the world's top 100 innovation clusters for the year 2026. Switzerland has retained the top position in the index for the 16th consecutive year. Several Asian economies feature prominently among the world's leading innovation performers alongside top global nations. The World Intellectual Property Organization publishes this index to track innovation performance globally. WIPO operates as a specialised agency of the United Nations to promote intellectual property protection and innovation.

When: 2026 · **Where:** Global · **Who:** World Intellectual Property Organization · **Prelims:** India's rank in GII 2026 is 38th.; Total economies covered in GII 2026 is 139.; Switzerland retained the top position for the 16th consecutive year.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides a critical benchmark for India's progress in science, technology, and research capabilities.; Helps policymakers identify strengths and weaknesses in India's innovation ecosystem to guide reforms.*

Static — The Global Innovation Index is published annually by the World Intellectual Property Organization to rank world economies on their innovation capabilities. WIPO is a specialised agency of the United Nations created in 1967 to encourage creative activity and promote the protection of intellectual property worldwide. The index evaluates a comprehensive set of indicators including institutions, human capital, research, infrastructure, market sophistication, and business sophistication.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Report/Index

ForumIAS: read the source · *free copy on studyiq.com*

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Inflation could hit 7%, forcing RBI to hike rates by 150 bps further: Report

A report by Systematix Institutional Equities warns that Indian inflation may reach 6-7 percent, crossing the RBI's 2-6 percent tolerance band. The surge is driven by rising input costs, higher household inflation expectations, and broadening price pressures across the economy. The report cautions that the RBI's inflation projections underestimate these mounting risks and inconsistencies in supply-demand assessments. Household inflation expectations averaged 9.1 percent in September 2026, staying significantly above headline inflation. Input costs for non-financial companies surged about 40 percent year-on-year in the first quarter of FY27 alongside a 45 percent jump in crude prices. Gross margins for companies contracted by 650-800 basis points as firms could only partially pass rising costs to consumers. Government subsidies and under-recoveries at oil marketing companies have cushioned inflationary impacts, but waning fiscal support will accelerate pipeline inflation. The RBI recently raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50 percent, marking the start of a calibrated tightening cycle. Restoring a real interest rate of at least 1 percent may require an additional 100-150 basis points of hikes, taking the terminal repo rate to 6.5-7 percent.

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Systematix Institutional Equities, Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** RBI's inflation tolerance band is 2-6 percent.; Household inflation expectations averaged 9.1 percent in September 2026.; The repo rate was hiked by 25 basis points to 5.50 percent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights risks to macroeconomic stability and consumer purchasing power from persistent supply-side inflation.; Indicates the likelihood of a higher terminal repo rate, affecting borrowing costs for consumers and corporates.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is India's central banking institution established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC), constituted under Section 45ZB of the RBI Act, is entrusted with fixing the benchmark policy

interest rate to contain inflation. The central bank operates under a flexible inflation targeting framework, mandated to maintain retail inflation at 4 percent with a band of +/- 2 percent.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on msn.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Retail inflation jumps to 5.54% in September

India's retail inflation based on the Consumer Price Index climbed to 5.54% in September from 4.83% in August. The sharp increase was primarily driven by a rise in the prices of food items, particularly vegetables. Food inflation based on the Consumer Food Price Index jumped significantly to 7.74% in September from 5.97% in August. Rural inflation outpaced urban inflation, hitting 6.08% compared to the urban rate of 4.88%. The inflation figure is rapidly approaching the upper threshold of the Reserve Bank of India's 2% to 6% tolerance band. External pressures including the US-Iran conflict and domestic price pressures from a weak monsoon contributed to the economic situation. In response to rising prices, the Reserve Bank of India increased the benchmark repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5% on October 7, 2026.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** Retail inflation in September stood at 5.54%.; August retail inflation was recorded at 4.83%.; Consumer Food Price Index inflation rose to 7.74% in September.

> ***Why it matters —*** *High retail inflation erodes purchasing power and directly impacts consumer welfare across India.; It forces monetary policy tightening by the Reserve Bank of India, leading to higher borrowing costs.*

Static — The Consumer Price Index measures retail price inflation for a basket of goods and services consumed by retail households. The Reserve Bank of India is mandated by the RBI Act of 1934 to maintain retail inflation at 4% with a band of +/- 2%. The Monetary Policy Committee determines the policy interest rate required to achieve the inflation target.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Report/Index

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by Indian Express

GS3 MAKE NOTES

US tariffs accelerate global trade realignment: How India’s FTAs could boost GDP

India's expanding network of free trade agreements could add around $140 billion to its gross domestic product by 2035. The agreements are projected to increase Indian exports by 6.2% by 2035 according to Bloomberg Economics. Rising US tariffs under President Donald Trump have reshaped global trade flows, prompting economies to seek preferential market access. The average US tariff rate rose to 10.7% in August 2025 from 2.3% in 2024, driven by sector and country-specific duties. India accelerated its FTA programme, with agreements involving EFTA, the UK, and Oman entering into force during 2025-26. India also signed an FTA with New Zealand, concluded negotiations with the EU, and is pursuing pacts with the EAEU and GCC. India faced additional US trade pressures in late 2025, including a 25% reciprocal tariff and a 25% duty on Russian oil purchases. Gains could be amplified through domestic reforms that strengthen manufacturing and help transition agricultural workers into higher-productivity sectors.

When: 2025-2035 · **Where:** India, United States, United Kingdom, Oman, New Zealand, European Union · **Who:** Bloomberg Economics, Donald Trump, Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** Bloomberg Economics estimated India's FTA gains at $140 billion in GDP by 2035.; The average US tariff rate stood at 10.7% in August 2025 compared to 2.3% in 2024.; India's FTAs with EFTA, the UK, and Oman entered into force during 2025-26.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights how trade diversification can insulate emerging economies from protectionist shocks.; Emphasizes the link between external trade pacts and domestic structural reforms in manufacturing and labor.*

Static — Free Trade Agreements are pacts between two or more nations to reduce or eliminate trade barriers like tariffs and quotas on goods and services. The Ministry of Commerce and Industry leads India's bilateral and regional trade negotiations through its Department of Commerce. India's recent modern trade partnerships include Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreements (CEPA) and Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreements (CECA).

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU, Data/Stats

Mint: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by Business Standard

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI launches Retail Direct: How retail investors can invest in Government Securities

The RBI introduced this platform to facilitate easy retail access to sovereign debt instruments. The Reserve Bank of India launched the Retail Direct scheme to enable retail investors to directly buy and sell government securities and treasury bills online.

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** Scheme launched by RBI; Targeted at retail investors; Covers Government Securities and Treasury Bills

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands the retail investor base in India's debt market.; Offers a risk-free investment option backed by the sovereign.*

Static — Government Securities (G-Secs) are tradable instruments issued by the Central Government or State Governments acknowledging the government's debt obligation. Treasury Bills (T-Bills) are short-term money market instruments issued by the Government of India with maturities of less than one year. Sovereign Gold Bonds (SGBs) are government securities denominated in grams of gold, acting as substitutes for holding

physical gold.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

The Economic Times: read the source

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

SC urged to urgently list contempt plea over alleged release of GM rice

The Supreme Court was urged to urgently list contempt petitions alleging violation of its 2024 judgment on genetically modified crops. The urgent listing was sought amid concerns over the alleged approval and cultivation of herbicide-tolerant GM basmati rice. Lawyer Prashant Bhushan made the mention before a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana. Bhushan argued that the contempt petitions arise from a 2024 common judgment and are separate from the pending reference on GM mustard. The contempt plea, filed by activist Aruna Rodrigues in 2025, seeks proceedings against senior government officials for wilful disobedience. The petition alleges the Centre violated the July 23, 2024 judgment directing a comprehensive national policy on GM crops before release. It alleges that herbicide-tolerant basmati rice brand RobiNOweed was released in May 2024, and gene-edited varieties Kamla and Pusa DST Rice 1 in May 2025. These alleged releases occurred despite the government's earlier assurance that no environmental release would happen before policy formulation.

When: 2026-10-12 · **Who:** Prashant Bhushan, Aruna Rodrigues, Chief Justice Surya Kant, Justice Joymalya Bagchi, Justice V Mohana · **Prelims:** The 2024 judgment on GM crops was delivered by Justices B V Nagarathna and Sanjay Karol.; The contempt petition was filed by activist Aruna Rodrigues as part of her PIL initiated in 2025.; Herbicide-tolerant basmati rice varieties were sold under the brand name RobiNOweed.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the ongoing legal and regulatory battles regarding the commercialization and environmental release of genetically modified and gene-edited crops in India.; Tests the enforceability of Supreme Court judgments and government assurances concerning agricultural biotechnology policy.*

Static — Genetically modified (GM) crops in India are regulated primarily under the Environment Protection Act, 1986, through the Genetic Engineering Appraisal Committee (GEAC). GEAC functions under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change and is the apex body for approval of commercial release of transgenic crops. Article 129 and Article 142 of the Constitution of India empower the Supreme Court to punish for contempt of its own orders and judgments.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Polity & Constitution, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Judgment

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on indiatoday.in*

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

ISRO Upcoming Missions: Gaganyaan, Chandrayaan-4 and BAS Timeline

ISRO released updated timelines regarding its upcoming space missions and orbital infrastructure plans. ISRO announced the roadmap and timelines for its upcoming flagship missions, including the Gaganyaan human spaceflight, Chandrayaan-4 lunar sample return, and the Bharatiya Antariksha Station (BAS).

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** India · **Who:** ISRO · **Prelims:** Gaganyaan aims to demonstrate human spaceflight capability.; Chandrayaan-4 involves lunar sample return.; BAS stands for Bharatiya Antariksha Station.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Marks India's progression towards human spaceflight capabilities and independent space station establishment.; Enhances India's technological prowess and scientific collaboration opportunities globally.*

Static — ISRO was founded on August 15, 1969, and functions under the Department of Space, Government of India, headquartered in Bengaluru. The Gaganyaan project contemplates launching a crew of three members to a 400 km orbit for a planned mission and bringing them back safely. Chandrayaan missions are India's lunar exploration programme aimed at studying the Moon's topography, mineralogy, and exosphere.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

www.rvcj.com: read the source

Internal Security

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Two merchant vessels with 22 Indians attacked in Strait of Hormuz

Two merchant vessels carrying 22 Indian crew members came under attack in the Strait of Hormuz region on October 11. The first ship, MT Petro Dolphin, was struck by a drone, resulting in two of its 11 Indian seafarers reported missing. The second ship, the Marshall Islands-flagged tanker MT Valthera, was struck by an unknown projectile, causing a fire onboard with all 11 Indian crew members reported safe. The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) strongly condemned the attacks on commercial vessels and civilian infrastructure. The Embassy of India in Muscat is closely monitoring the situation and coordinating with Omani authorities and ship management companies. India emphasized that the safety and security of Indian seafarers remain a top priority for the government. India called for immediate de-escalation, conflict resolution through dialogue and diplomacy, and the upholding of freedom of navigation in international waterways.

When: 2026-10-12 · **Where:** Strait of Hormuz · **Who:** Ministry of External Affairs, Indian Seafarers, Embassy of India in Muscat · **Prelims:** Two merchant vessels came under attack in the Strait of Hormuz on October 11.; MT Petro Dolphin was struck by a drone with two of its 11 Indian seafarers reported missing.; MT Valthera is a Marshall Islands-flagged tanker that was struck by an unknown projectile.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the persistent security risks faced by Indian seafarers working in volatile geopolitical flashpoints.; Underscores India's diplomatic stance on protecting its nationals abroad and upholding freedom of navigation under international law.*

Static — The Strait of Hormuz is a critical international waterway connecting the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea. It is a vital chokepoint for global energy supplies, through which a significant portion of the world's petroleum passes daily. Commercial shipping in the region is protected under international maritime law, ensuring the freedom of navigation and unimpeded flow of commerce.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Internal Security, Geography · Prelims angle: Place in news

theprint.in: read the source · also reported by All India Radio (NewsOnAir)

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

PM-SETU Achieves Another Milestone with Signing of Shareholders Agreements for Surat and Visakhapatnam Clusters; Rs. 440 Crore Approved for Upgradation of Nine Government ITIs

On October 12, 2026, PM-SETU approved Rs. 440 crore to upgrade nine Government Industrial Training Institutes in Surat and Visakhapatnam. The initiative is driven by Shareholders' Agreements signed between the Directorate General of Training, MSDE, state governments, and AM/NS India. The partnership covers five Government ITIs in Surat, Gujarat, and four Government ITIs in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Secretary (Power) holds Bilateral Meeting with the European Commissions Director General for Taxation and Customs Union- Mr. Gerassimos Thomas

A bilateral meeting took place between Indian and European Commission officials to discuss carbon trading and border carbon adjustment mechanisms. The Power Secretary and the European Commission's Director-General for Taxation and Customs Union met in New Delhi to discuss carbon markets, the EU's CBAM, and technical cooperation.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT QUICK READ

Neither approved nor disapproved, Supreme Court clarifies stance on Form 6 alterations

The Supreme Court clarified that it has neither approved nor disapproved the Election Commission of India's revised Form 6 for voter registration. The clarification was issued after a petitioner argued that the ECI had represented the revised Form 6 as having Supreme Court approval. A bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana stated that the issue never came up during the Bihar SIR matter.

Bar & Bench: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

TDB-DST signs agreement with Peptris for Rs. 86 crore RDI support to accelerate AI-driven drug discovery and development

The agreement was signed to advance the VIGOR project for accelerating AI-discovered drug candidates from bench to clinic.

PIB: source

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

India-Kazakhstan Joint Military Exercise KAZIND 2026 Concludes in Oskemen

The ninth edition of the India-Kazakhstan joint military exercise KAZIND 2026 concluded successfully at Oskemen, Kazakhstan. The exercise aimed to enhance interoperability, tactical coordination, and joint counter-terrorism capabilities in a sub-conventional environment. The closing phase featured a rigorous 72-hour validation exercise showcasing operational readiness and joint combat skills. Earlier drills included tactical navigation through the Akhmirovo Training Area and live-firing exercises.

ianslive.in: source

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

EXERCISE TARANG SHAKTI 2026: POWER IN PARTNERSHIP, STRENGTH IN SELF-RELIANCE

The second edition of the multinational air exercise Tarang Shakti concluded at Air Force Station Jodhpur on Monday after running from September 26 to October 12, 2026. Hosted by the Indian Air Force under the theme 'Power in Partnership', the exercise aimed to strengthen operational cooperation, interoperability, and defence partnerships.

PIB: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Launching of 116th Round of Quarterly Industrial Outlook Survey (IOS) - Q3:2026-27

The RBI announced the official launch of these two quarterly outlook surveys for the reference period October-December 2026. The Reserve Bank of India has launched the 116th round of the Industrial Outlook Survey for manufacturing and the 51st round of the Services and Infrastructure Outlook Survey for Q3:2026-27.

RBI: source

ECONOMY AWARD QUICK READ

2026 Nobel Prize in Economics

Robert E Hall and Michael Woodford have won the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences. They won the award for their work on the microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation. The award was announced in Stockholm by the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences. The prestigious prize is formally known as the Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel.

Hindustan Times: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION APPOINTMENT QUICK READ

President Murmu appoints Governors in six states

President Droupadi Murmu has appointed new Governors across six states. Om Prakash Mathur, previously the Governor of Sikkim, is now appointed as the Governor of Keralam. Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar, former Governor of Keralam, has been moved to serve as the Governor of Tamil Nadu. Braj Mohan Ram has been appointed as the Governor of Odisha.

newsonair.gov.in: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Cabinet Approves Uttarakhand Floodplain Zoning Rules To Regulate Land Use In Flood-Prone Areas

The Uttarakhand cabinet approved the Uttarakhand Floodplain Zoning Rules, 2026 to regulate land use in vulnerable flood-prone areas. The new rules enforce the provisions of the Uttarakhand Floodplain Zoning Act, 2012 by establishing operational frameworks and standards. The cabinet approved forming a society for the Shri Madan Mohan Malviya Prachya Shodh Sansthan in Rishikul, Haridwar.

outlookindia.com: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Forum proposes draft Bill seeking protection for advocates, their kin, staff in Keralam

The draft Bill was reported in the media as a proactive step proposed by a forum seeking legal safety for legal professionals. A forum has proposed the Keralam Advocates Protection Bill, 2021, to safeguard lawyers, their relatives, and staff from assault and intimidation.

The Hindu: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Tamil Nadu Government Launches ‘Annan Seer’ Scheme

The Tamil Nadu government issued an order to implement the Annan Seer scheme to assist eligible brides. The scheme was launched to fulfill a key poll promise made by Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay. The core issue centers on providing material and financial support to economically vulnerable families for marriages. Eligible brides will receive an 8-gram, 22-carat gold coin and a silk saree under the scheme.

drishtiias.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

The gaps in the implementation of the RTI Act

The Right to Information Act has completed 21 years, bringing attention to persistent gaps in proactive disclosure despite improvements in transparency audits. The RTI Act was enacted to promote transparency, accountability and informed citizen participation in governance by empowering Indian citizens to access information. Section 4 of the Act requires public authorities to maintain records and proactively disclose prescribed information to reduce individual applications.

The Hindu: source

DEFENCE | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

Exercise KONKAN-26

INS Trishul arrived at Plymouth, UK, to participate in Exercise KONKAN-26 with the Royal Navy. The bilateral maritime exercise is conducted between India and the UK to strengthen seamless operational capabilities. The 2026 edition of the exercise is being conducted off Plymouth, UK, from 08 to 15 October 2026. The inaugural edition of Exercise KONKAN was conducted in 2004.

ForumIAS: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

S.69 Indian Succession Act | Kerala High Court Upholds Law On Automatic Revocation Of Christian Wills...

The ruling was delivered following legal challenges against the automatic revocation provision applicable to Christian wills under the Indian Succession Act. The Kerala High Court upheld the constitutional validity of Section 69 of the Indian Succession Act, which dictates the automatic revocation of a will upon the marriage of the testator.

LiveLaw: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Nameri Tiger Reserve Receives CA|TS Approval

Nameri Tiger Reserve in Assam received Conservation Assured | Tiger Standards (CA|TS) Approved status in September 2026. The recognition was given for meeting prescribed norms for tiger conservation and protected area management. With this inclusion, all four tiger reserves in Assam, namely Kaziranga, Manas, Orang, and Nameri, have achieved CA|TS Approved status. CA|TS is a global framework designed to assess the effectiveness of tiger reserve management and protection.

drishtiias.com: source

DEFENCE | QUICK READ

INDIAN NAVAL SHIP TARKASH TO PARTICIPATE IN IBSAMAR IX 2026, REAFFIRMING INDIA’S COMMITMENT TO MARITIME COOPERATION

INS Tarkash is on an overseas deployment to South Africa to participate in the ninth edition of the IBSAMAR IX 2026 trilateral maritime exercise. The trilateral maritime exercise brings together the Indian, Brazilian and South African Navies with the aim of enhancing interoperability, strengthening maritime cooperation and promoting mutual understanding amongst the participating forces.

PIB: source

ECONOMY | SCHEME | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Government allows 5,841 tonnes of sugar export to EU under quota-based duty concession scheme

The government has permitted the export of 5,841 tonnes of sugar to the European Union under a tariff rate quota scheme. The Directorate General of Foreign Trade notified this quota-based duty concession scheme for the period of 2026-27. The sugar export period under this notification spans from October 2026 to September 2027.

Economic Times: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | JUDGMENT | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Katchatheevu Island

Sri Lankan President Anura Kumara Dissanayake stated that India has acknowledged before the Supreme Court that Katchatheevu is part of Sri Lanka. The statement highlights ongoing discussions and historical maritime boundary agreements regarding the small island located in the Palk Strait. Katchatheevu is a small, uninhabited island situated 33 km northeast of Rameswaram and 62 km southwest of Jaffna.

ForumIAS: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | QUICK READ

Bihar cabinet approves five new airports, nine heliports

The Bihar cabinet approved a proposal to improve air connectivity by operationalising five new airports and nine heliports across the state. The new airports will be built in Kishanganj, Saran, Begusarai, Araria, and Gopalganj districts. The nine heliports will be constructed in Aurangabad, Banka, Jamui, Katihar, Khagaria, Nawada, Sheikhpura, and Sitamarhi districts.

newindianexpress.com: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Pilibhit's Ramsar bid stalls as irrigation dept withholds dam data

Efforts to secure Ramsar site status for the Sharda Sagar Dam have stalled because the irrigation department refused to share required technical details. The irrigation department cited concerns regarding dam safety, irrigation operations, and local livelihoods to withhold the data requested by district authorities. A turf war also emerged after forest officials objected to the irrigation department auctioning commercial fishing rights in the reservoir.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | AWARD | QUICK READ

Gujarat: 3 districts win national awards for irrigation, governance under farm development scheme

The districts were recently announced as winners of national awards for agricultural and governance achievements. Three districts in Gujarat have won national awards for their performance in irrigation and governance under a farm development scheme.

Social News XYZ: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 GS3 The AI Challenge How to Maximise Economic Impact, Spread Gains Evenly

Global AI investment has largely concentrated on advanced models, chips, and data centres, but development gains rely on applying AI to practical problems at scale. Only 4.5 percent of jobs in low- and middle-income countries are highly exposed to generative AI automation, presenting a lower risk of job displacement. Another 16.2 percent of jobs in developing nations can experience meaningful productivity gains, as AI complements human labour and expands expertise access.

ForumIAS

GS2 UPSC Editorial Analysis: The Evolution of India's Rural Employment Guarantee

The transition from MGNREGA 2005 to the revamped Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission Gramin (VB-G RAM G) marks a significant shift in rural policy. Recent Ministry of Rural Development data shows a drop of 9.56 crore person-days generated during the July-August period compared to the previous year. This trend has ignited a major policy debate within Indian governance, macroeconomic management, and federal relations. The restructured scheme introduces a mandatory 60-day operational pause during peak agricultural sowing and harvesting seasons.

Insights on India

GS2 GS3 A digital India needs Wi-fi for everyone

India has made major progress in digital payments and mobile data, but public Wi-Fi remains underdeveloped with only around four lakh hotspots compared to millions in countries like France. The Department of Telecommunications launched the PM-WANI scheme to accelerate internet proliferation by setting up public Wi-Fi hotspots across the country. Under PM-WANI, Public Data Offices establish and operate WANI-compliant Wi-Fi hotspots by partnering with Public Data Office Aggregators to deliver affordable internet services.

ForumIAS

GS3 The next farm revolution must aim at significantly raising farmers' incomes

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has completed 25 years in public service, including 13 years as Gujarat CM and 12 years as India's Prime Minister. Gujarat agriculture grew at over 9 percent per annum during his tenure as CM through check dams, Narmada water, feeder line separation, and Krishi Mahotsav. During his tenure as Prime Minister, India faced back-to-back droughts in 2014 and 2015, prompting high priority for water irrigation and crop insurance.

ForumIAS

GS1 GS3 Warming Himalayas Demand a Rethink on Development

The Indian Himalayan Region faces frequent and severe climate-induced disasters as temperatures rise at 0.3 degC per decade, nearly twice the global average. Warming triggers rapid glacier loss, permafrost thaw, slope instability, and black-carbon accumulation from sources like brick kilns. Unsafe infrastructure planning, uncontrolled tourism, and high-altitude hydropower construction ignore fragile geological conditions. Ice-loss rates across the Hindu Kush Himalaya have doubled since 2000, and western Himalaya is warming faster than other stretches.

The Hindu

GS3 How Robert Hall & Michael Woodward's Nobel-winning insights reshape economic policy in times of crisis

The discussion focuses on the ongoing relevance of their economic frameworks in guiding central bank responses during major global crises. An editorial discussing how the Nobel-winning economic insights of Robert Hall and Michael Woodward have reshaped crisis management and central bank policies. Central banks have established a systematic approach to managing economic crises through coordinated policies. Scholars Robert Hall and Michael Woodward contributed crucial insights into the effectiveness of countercyclical measures at an individual level.

Economic Times

GS2 Election Commission faces growing rift with voters, opposition and its own system

The rising criticism over engagement practices and responses to inquiries has put the Election Commission's credibility in the news. The Election Commission of India faces growing public discontent and distrust from voters, political parties, and its own system regarding transparency and engagement practices. The escalating public discontent towards the Election Commission of India is a clear indicator of the increasing distrust surrounding electoral processes. Concerns about their connection with both voters and political parties are on the rise.

Economic Times

GS2 Strategic neutrality to active interlocutor: India's push for a Russia-Ukraine peace agreement

India has evolved its foreign policy stance from cautious neutrality to an active diplomatic intermediary in the Russia-Ukraine war. Initially, New Delhi maintained a balanced approach by preserving historic ties with Moscow and purchasing discounted energy while aiding Ukraine. The strategic shift culminated in high-level visits by PM Narendra Modi to Moscow and Kyiv, followed by backchannel diplomacy by S Jaishankar and Ajit Doval. India's current peace push is anchored in a concrete, three-part ceasefire plan targeting immediate economic and humanitarian pain points.

Hindustan Times

GS2 At sixes and sevens, the ECI’s growing credibility crisis

Questions and public debates regarding Forms 6 and 7 have put the Election Commission's neutrality under intense scrutiny. The editorial highlights how controversies surrounding Forms 6 and 7 have deepened doubts regarding the Election Commission of India's impartiality and transparency. The Election Commission of India’s actions and questions around Forms 6 and 7 deepen doubts about its impartiality and transparency

The Hindu

GS3 Good and simple tax: How the GST Council's latest reforms are finally making it a reality

Recent procedural changes approved by the GST Council have put GST reforms back into the spotlight. Significant procedural reforms approved by the GST Council are working to make the goods and services tax simpler nearly a decade after its adoption in India. The procedural changes approved by the GST Council could go a long way towards realizing its economic promise.

Mint

GS2 The need to preserve the shine of Indian elections

Published as an opinion piece in The Hindu to examine the ongoing significance and challenges of Indian elections. An editorial discussing the vital importance of preserving the integrity, credibility, and shine of the electoral process in Indian democracy. Elections are by far the best organised expression of “we, the people” and hence cannot be allowed to fail

The Hindu

GS3 Drought report: on southwest monsoon, drought in Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh

The publication of drought reports and monsoon outcomes in Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh. The editorial highlights the urgency for the Centre to provide timely drought relief to Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh following the southwest monsoon assessment by inter-ministerial teams. The Centre must help States once inter-ministerial team gives finding

The Hindu

GS2 What’s the counterweight to ECI? A Supreme Court of not-yets, not-nows, not-heres

Recent reports show two Election Commissioners objected 14 times in 10 months to actions taken by the Chief Election Commissioner. The ECI is answerable to Parliament through impeachment, but opposition motions have been rejected by presiding officers. The Supreme Court serves as the primary independent body capable of holding the ECI accountable in practice. An analysis of six years of court data reveals that the Supreme Court rarely rules against the Election Commission.

ThePrint

GS2 Delhi clampdown : Supreme Court bats for constitutional freedom

The Supreme Court intervened in the ongoing protests in Delhi, ruling that maintaining law and order cannot come at the cost of constitutional freedom. The Court directed authorities to prevent illegal detention, restore normal metro services, and ensure uninterrupted Internet access subject to law. Protests organised by the Cockroach Janta Party and student organisations against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar triggered heavy security measures. Authorities detained more than 7,000 people on Saturday and hundreds on Sunday, raising serious questions about the proportionality of police action.

tribuneindia.com

GS2 The EC is doing a better job than the judiciary with its ‘virtue-signalling’ judges

Justice Ujjal Bhuyan criticised the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls at a recent event, stating it disenfranchises millions. The author argues that a sitting judge commenting on a matter pending before the Supreme Court constitutes premature virtue-signalling. The core debate contrasts the Election Commission's imperfect but correctible electoral roll revisions with the judiciary's systemic failures. Justice Bhuyan used the term whataboutery to dismiss counter-arguments, which the author calls a way to shut down scrutiny of judicial hypocrisy.

ThePrint

GS3 Inches, not just percentages: India’s GDP is rising, but a four-inch gap with China tells another story

Indian economic discourse is trapped in an exhausting loop focusing excessively on headline GDP growth figures to the first decimal point. Goodhart's Law dictates that when a measure becomes a target, it ceases to be a good measure of actual national progress. China's development shows world-class infrastructure and a biological marker of holistic progress: teenagers are significantly taller than their parents.

Economic Times

GS3 The era of easy money is over: RBI repo rate hike to 5.5%, what it means

The policy update was reported amid evolving macroeconomic indicators and central bank measures to manage liquidity. The Reserve Bank of India has raised the repo rate to 5.5%, signifying a definitive end to the era of cheap and easy money.

Deccan Herald

GS2 Russia's Trump card in the Ukraine war

US President Donald Trump has signed a deal with Russia for the immediate supply of 300,000 tonnes of diesel to the global market. The agreement includes subsequent supplies of 500,000 tonnes in November and a million tonnes thereafter, contingent on Russian refinery operations. This deal marks a striking policy reversal given that Trump previously legislated sanctions against nations purchasing oil from Russia and Iran. The development follows Trump's public criticism of Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky in February 2025 over conflict resolution plans.

Hindustan Times

GS3 GST reforms step in right direction. Businesses need protection from coercive tax enforcement

The author highlights the Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council's announcements at its 57th General Meeting on 8 October regarding compliance and enforcement reforms. The core argument is that businesses need protection from coercive tax enforcement, distinguishing ordinary tax compliance failures from criminal conduct. Under the CGST Act 2017, Sections 69 and 132 empowered Commissioners to order arrests, which had raised concerns regarding personal liberty under Article 21.

ThePrint

GS3 Fake firms, mule accounts, fake invoices. GST fraud is now a service industry

Central GST officers in Meerut uncovered 232 shell firms sharing a single mobile number, involving goods-less invoices worth Rs 5,842 crore and Rs 1,048 crore in ineligible input tax credit. DGGI previously detected a Jaipur beneficiary firm utilizing ineligible credit from shell firms in Sonipat and Delhi through fake invoices. A Ghaziabad-based individual created, operated, and sold 294 shell firms to pass on ineligible ITC of Rs 1,033 crore for a commission of 1.25 percent.

ThePrint

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) – Significance & Challenges The Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), 1967 is India's primary anti-terror and national security legislation designed to protect sovereignty and integrity. The law was originally enacted in 1967 to ban unlawful associations and prevent secessionist movements threatening national integration.

ForumIAS

Appointments in Election Commission of India The Election Commission oversees the electoral roll process, announces election dates, and ensures the Model Code of Conduct is followed during elections. State Election Commissions handle elections to panchayats and municipalities, while the Election Commission of India oversees parliamentary and state legislature elections.

The Hindu

Can rate hikes control cost-push inflation? Cost-push inflation happens when prices rise due to increased production costs like oil, gas, electricity, and transportation. Global wars, tariff conflicts, and geopolitical uncertainties drive up production costs globally, leading central banks to hike interest rates. Central banks raise interest rates to reduce credit demand, making borrowing expensive for businesses and consumers.

ForumIAS

Nobel Prize in Economics 2026: How Hall, Woodford reshaped modern economic policy The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences awarded the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences to Americans Robert Hall and Michael Woodford. The prize recognizes their groundbreaking work on the microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilization. Robert Hall is a professor at Stanford University, while Michael Woodford is a macroeconomist and monetary theorist at Columbia University.

msn.com

Saudi-Houthi conflict and the Mecca pact: What Pakistan, Turkey can and cannot do Yemen's Houthi militia escalated cross-border aerial strikes against critical infrastructure in Saudi Arabia. The Mecca Defense Agreement came into force on October 5, 2026, creating a mutual defense treaty between Saudi Arabia, Pakistan, and Turkey. The pact mandates that aggression against one signatory is legally treated as an attack against all member nations.

msn.com

Explained | RBI's worries about pressure on rupee and measures to curb volatility in forex market The RBI highlighted concerns over currency pressures and introduced steps to strengthen market discipline. The Reserve Bank of India announced regulatory measures to curb volatility in the foreign exchange market and manage depreciation pressure on the rupee.

The Hindu

Knowledge Nugget | State of the World's Forests 2026: Key highlights for UPSC Exam It was featured as a knowledge nugget for UPSC aspirants to understand recent global forest assessments. The State of the World's Forests 2026 report highlights key global forestry trends, challenges, and policy recommendations for sustainable management.

Indian Express

Jantar Mantar 'denotified' as protest site: How it became Delhi's hub for dissent Delhi Police withdrew Jantar Mantar's status as a designated protest site through an order issued on October 11 by Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar. Three alternative venues were designated: Ramlila Maidan, CBD Ground in East Delhi, and Burari Ground in North Delhi.
millenniumpost.in

Why does India need a trained workforce for elderly care? It is in the news due to the projected growth of India's elderly population to 347 million by 2050 and the push for formal caregiving frameworks. This explainer details why India requires a trained workforce for elderly care as the 60-plus population expands significantly toward 2050.
The Hindu

Flash floods in Nepal again: Warning bells for Himalaya, lessons for India Fresh flash floods occurred in Nepal, prompting renewed concerns about Himalayan disaster preparedness and regional safety. Recent flash floods in Nepal have underscored the acute climate and geological vulnerabilities of the Himalayan ecosystem, offering critical lessons for downstream India.
Indian Express

Delhi protests against CEC: What the law says about preventive detention The Supreme Court issued directions in response to protests against the CEC and concerns over illegal detentions in Delhi. The Supreme Court directed authorities to cease illegal detentions and ensure smooth transport operations during Delhi protests against the CEC, subject to public order.
The Hindu

Trump jumps the gun once again: Have Russia and Ukraine agreed to energy ceasefire? Remarks by Donald Trump triggered discussions regarding whether Russia and Ukraine agreed to halt attacks on energy infrastructure. Speculation arose over statements suggesting Russia and Ukraine may have discussed or reached an energy ceasefire.
Firstpost

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Supreme Court Reserves Verdict On Whether High Courts Can Hear Anticipatory Bail Pleas Bypassing Sessions Courts (Polity & Constitution) LawChakra
- Five Years of PM GatiShakti: Transforming India's Infrastructure Planning (Infrastructure & Energy) PIB
- Union Environment Minister Inaugurates New Office Premises of International Big Cat Alliance (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- Union Minister Shri Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan Singh, Holds Bilateral Talks with UK Secretary of State Dame Angela Eagle to Deepen Cooperation in Animal Husbandry and Allied Sectors (International Relations) PIB
- BRICS Theatre Festival 2026 Commences Today at National School of Drama in New Delhi (History, Art & Culture) PIB
- 'Rahul Gandhi vs Election Commission': Supreme Court Hearing Likely Tomorrow (Polity & Constitution) NDTV
- IMD Dedicates Cyclone Warning and Marine Weather Services Decision Support System to the Nation on 12th October, 2026 (Disaster Management) PIB
- NHRC, India celebrates its 33rd Foundation Day in New Delhi (Polity & Constitution) PIB
- Ministry of Rural Development Brings National SARAS Mela 2026 to Vijayawada for the First Time outside Delhi-NCR, in Collaboration with Andhra Pradesh Government (Governance & Policy) PIB
- Rice, maize and cereal acreage declines warrant monitoring: Report (Agriculture & Allied) BusinessLine
- The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) (Polity & Constitution) Insights on India
- Inflation breaches RBI's 4% target for fourth straight month (Economy) Mint
- Gadchiroli Tops NITI Aayog's Aspirational Districts Programme Ranking (Governance & Policy) Drishti IAS
- India's BRICS Chairship to Host $1 Trn Global Sovereign Capital Summit (Economy) https://www.fintechbiznews.com/
- Monocracy In Election Commission: Testing Statutory Consensus Under 2023 CEC Act (Polity & Constitution) Live Law
- Union Health Minister Shri Jagat Prakash Nadda lays foundation stone of ICMR Centre for High Altitude Medicine and Public Health Research at Keylong (Health) PIB
- Union Minister Shri G. Kishan Reddy Launches Commercialisation Catalogue of Technologies Developed under Various Sponsored Programmes (Science & Technology) PIB
- As rising waters flood homes and temples, villagers protest India's $87 billion river-linking project (Environment & Ecology) Internazionale
- Inflation nears RBI's 6 per cent upper tolerance limit; economists see upside risks, rate hike possibility (Economy) ANI News
- "Indian Telecom Services Performance Indicator Report" for the Quarter April - June, 2026 (Economy) PIB
- India, UK to exchange tariff usage data under trade agreement (Economy) Mint
- India's Tiger Reserves Will Now Be Assessed on Solid Waste Management (Environment & Ecology) The Better India
- VB-G RAM G: Minister orders show-cause notices as 311 panchayats report delay in payments (Governance & Policy) The Hindu
- Submer India, BSNL Tower Corporation to develop AI-ready data centres across India (Infrastructure & Energy) ET Telecom
- Securities and Exchange Board of India (Portfolio Managers) Regulations, 2026 (With effect from April 1, 2027)" (Economy) SEBI
- Top 10 Most Populated Country in the World, Rank Wise List (Society) Vajiram & Ravi
- Centre to set up high-level committee within a week to address sugarcane farmers' grievances (Agriculture & Allied) Economic Times
- RBI Tightens Forex Derivatives Rules: Implications for the Indian Economy (Economy) NEXT IAS

- Bihar Green Hydrogen Policy, 2026 (Environment & Ecology) Drishti IAS
- 8-month-old cheetah cub dies at Kuno National Park, India's population falls to 59 (Environment & Ecology) News9live
- BCI Protest Assault: Supreme Court Directs Delhi Police Commissioner To Constitute SIT, Report To... (Polity & Constitution) LawBeat
- Beyond 1.4 Billion Aadhaar Enrolments and 20 Billion Monthly UPI Transactions, India's Next Digital Challenge Is Connecting Government Data: TBI Report (Governance & Policy) TheWire.in
- Dhal Singh Bisen appointed new Governor of Uttarakhand (Polity & Constitution) ThePrint
- Poorest 10% In Rich Countries Earn More Than India's Richest 10%: World Bank (Economy) NDTV
- Karnataka govt launches ELEVATE schemes to boost inclusive, DeepTech entrepreneurship (Economy) ThePrint
- EU Pushes COP31 Climate Deal to Accelerate Global Emissions Cuts (Environment & Ecology) ESG News
- Flash Floods in Himalayas: Causes, Impacts and NDMA Guidelines (Disaster Management) Insights on India
- Saudi Arabia: Geography, Oil Reserves & Strategic Importance (Geography) Insights on India
- Supreme Court wants cap on trade margin for all essential medicines and medical products (Governance & Policy) The Hindu
- Tribunal Reforms Bill 2026 seeks to strengthen independence, transparency of tribunal system (Polity & Constitution) DD News
- India's poverty rate seen falling to 12.1% by 2028, says World Bank (Economy) Business Standard
- India Plans Ayush Chair At Durban University To Boost Ayurveda Education, Traditional Medicine Research In (Education) Free Press Journal
- EU's carbon rules enter implementation phase, putting Indian MSMEs under pressure (Environment & Ecology) Down To Earth
- World's First Nuclear Clock (Science & Technology) NEXT IAS
- "Waste no more time arguing what a good man should be. Be one." (Ethics & Integrity) Insights on India
- WWF Report: Global wildlife populations decline 73% since 1970; freshwater hit hardest (Environment & Ecology) CNBC TV18
- Western Ghats ESA: Seventh draft faces six-state resistance as conservation hangs in balance (Environment & Ecology) Down To Earth
- Sonar, torpedoes, guarding coasts: Navy commissions indigenous INS Mangrol (Defence) Indian Express
- Rahul Gandhi, Kharge move SC over SIR, seek independent audit of voter rolls (Polity & Constitution) Nagaland Tribune
- India's industrial output grows 7.3% in June; manufacturing expands 7.8% (Economy) DD News
- Government moves to set up mineral exchange, 5 commodities to be traded initially (Economy) The Times of India
- In a first, India's renewable power generation surpasses 100 BUs in a quarter (Infrastructure & Energy) BusinessLine
- September 2026 second warmest on record, global temperatures exceed: C3S (Environment & Ecology) Hindustan Times
- UPSC Key: Right to Protest, Trump's Russian diesel deal and Quantum Computing (Polity & Constitution) Indian Express
- Indian debt funds set to extend $4.5 billion bond selloff after RBI policy shift (Economy) The Hindu
- Preventive Detention and Right to Protest (Polity & Constitution) NEXT IAS
- SHANTI Rules 2026 (Science & Technology) Observer Research Foundation

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 22 must-know, 22 Prelims facts, 57 in the news, 20 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (10), Economy (9), Governance & Policy (6), International Relations (5), Defence (4), Environment & Ecology (3), Science & Technology (2), Social Justice & Welfare (1), Health (1), Internal Security (1), Disaster Management (1), Infrastructure & Energy (1). **Nothing today in —** Education, Agriculture & Allied, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 5 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 1 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 3 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 4

Full text — 51 of 76 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 13, PIB 8, ForumIAS 8, Economic Times 7, ThePrint 4, msn.com 3, Hindustan Times 3, ddnews.gov.in 2, Mint 2, Bar & Bench 2, Insights on India 2, drishtiias.com 2, Indian Express 2, The Law Observer 1

Built 04 Nov 2026, 00:02 IST by UPSC Intel. Notes quote the reports; check the source before quoting a figure in an answer.